Joaquin Gonzalez-Salgado

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Education

Harvey Mudd College — Claremont, CA
Bachelor of Science in Electrical and Computer Engineering — GPA: 3.7/4.0 — *Expected May 2028*

Experience

Electrical and Firmware Engineer Intern (Incoming) — Jan. 2027 – May 2027
Strata Robotics — *Sunnyvale, CA*

- Will support V1 electrical bring-up of an outdoor construction robot: debugging power-electronics and mixed-signal boards and STM32 firmware networked with an NVIDIA Jetson Orin

Electrical Engineer, Sponsored Engineering Project — Aug. 2026 – Present
Blue Origin — *Claremont, CA*

- Selecting and validating a redundant multi-sensor suite (radar, LiDAR, proximity, IMU, computer vision) to track vehicle-side launch umbilical panels, weighing accuracy, cost, harsh-environment reliability, and EMI risk
- Integrating sensor data into control logic with Kalman filtering to align ground-side umbilical panels in all 6 degrees of freedom to about 0.1 mm for automated mating of propellant, power, and data lines
- Own component selection, sensor packaging design, and hardware procurement for the full-scale model

Hardware & Firmware Researcher — Aug. 2025 – Present
Analog Circuitry Engineering Lab — *Claremont, CA*

- Designed low-noise analog front ends with impedance matching, instrumentation amplifiers, and up to 7,000x gain, moving a dual-battery instrument to a single-supply design with integrated battery management
- Brought up and verified 4 PCB revisions in a 10-week sprint (2 single-supply analog boards, 2 nRF5340 microcontroller boards), debugging power faults with oscilloscopes, function generators, and bench supplies
- Developed nRF5340 firmware on the Zephyr RTOS with SPI, I2C, and ADC drivers to configure gain, offset, and excitation on the analog board, plus Bluetooth firmware that streams data to client software in real time

PCB Designer, Electrical Team — Sep. 2025 – Present
MuddSub Autonomous Underwater Vehicle Team (RoboSub) — *Claremont, CA*

- Contributing to the electrical team's KiCad design of Rev. 1 power and signal boards for an 8-thruster AUV, now entering fabrication and verification
- Boards convert separate thruster and electronics batteries into 12V/5V/3.3V rails via switching regulators and route a Teensy 4.1 driving 8 thruster PWM channels with relay and hardware-kill control

Projects

36V Electric Vehicle | *Power Distribution, Circuit Protection, Raspberry Pi* — Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Led a team building a 36V electric vehicle that holds a steady 15 mph by designing its power distribution and protection system (motor controllers, relays, fuses, breakers)

IR Laser Tag System | *FPGA Design, Embedded Firmware, IR Communication* — Oct. 2026 – Present

- Building a two-player IR laser tag system on a Lattice iCE40 FPGA and STM32, with FPGA logic that encodes 38 kHz IR packets and decodes hits into SPI interrupts to the MCU

Autonomous Underwater Vehicle | *Signal Conditioning, Embedded Firmware, Controls* — Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Programmed Teensy 4.0 firmware for GPS surface navigation, pressure-based P-control dives, and 7.1 kHz burst ADC sampling with SD logging; team won 1st place at the course showcase

NFC Business Card PCB | *Antenna Design, Impedance Matching, VNA, PCB Design* — Jul. 2026 – Aug. 2026

- Designed and assembled a 2-layer NFC business card around an NXP NT3H2111 tag IC with a custom PCB-trace loop antenna, impedance-matching the antenna to the 13.56 MHz NFC carrier with VNA measurements

Technical Skills

Hardware: Schematic Capture, PCB Layout & Bring-Up, Power Distribution, nRF5340, STM32, ESP32

Firmware & Embedded: Zephyr RTOS, I2C, SPI, UART, CAN, Bluetooth, ADC, PWM, IoT

Engineering Software: Altium, KiCad, LTspice, Lattice Radiant, Questa, Quartus, LabVIEW, Fusion CAD

Languages & Tools: Python, C, C++, MATLAB, Verilog, SystemVerilog, VHDL, Git, CMake, Jupyter

Lab Instrumentation: Oscilloscope, Multimeter, Function Generator, Power Supply, VNA, Data Acquisition